

Problems to know

As the class progresses towards the first exam, the problems you are responsible to understand for the exam will be added here.

1. **Heap of Beans.** There are 16 beans in a pile. Two people playing against each other take turns removing either 1, 2, or 3 beans from the pile on each turn. The person who removes the last bean(s) wins the game. Describe a winning strategy for this game!
2. **Two Bean Heaps.** Make two heaps of beans with 10 beans in each heap. You and a partner alternate moves until all the beans are gone. The winner is who takes the last bean(s). A move consists of removing one bean from one of the piles, or of removing a bean from each pile. What is a winning strategy?
3. **Changing 50 cents.** In how many ways can you change a 50 cent piece?
4. **Milk and Coffee.** An 8-ounce cup of coffee and an 8-ounce cup of milk are sitting side by side. You take an ounce of milk and stir it into the coffee. Then you take an ounce of the mixture and stir it back in the milk. Is there more milk in the coffee or coffee in the milk, or is it equal?